THATO MAKHUSHA

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GitHub: https://github.com/thatomakhusha | Portfolio: https://thatomakhushaportfolio.vercel.app/

PROFILE

Software Engineering student at Eduvos (BSc IT), driven by a deep passion for building secure software that solves real problems. I design, build and deploy full-stack web applications with Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS and Supabase, have delivered live websites for real clients, and built Pursuit for the FNB App of the Year Hackathon 2026. I keep learning beyond the classroom through Cisco cybersecurity training, the FNB App Academy and personal projects like BitBunker, with the goal of building a career in software engineering and cybersecurity.

Seeking bursaries, internships, learnerships and training opportunities.

SKILLS

Core technologies: JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Supabase (Auth, Row Level Security), Git & GitHub, Vercel, Responsive Web Development

Currently learning: Java, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST API design, JUnit, Python (fundamentals)

Security: Cybersecurity fundamentals (Cisco, in progress)

SEO & Web Visibility: Google Search Console and Google search tools to get new websites indexed and found on Google

Tools: Visual Studio Code, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Access)

Soft skills: Communication, Problem Solving, Time Management, Teamwork

PROJECTS

Pursuit – Opportunity & Application Tracker

Oct 2026

Next.js | TypeScript | Tailwind CSS | Supabase | Vercel

Live: https://pursuit-brown-ten.vercel.app/ | GitHub: https://github.com/thatomakhusha/pursuit

- Solo-built for the FNB App of the Year Hackathon 2026: a full-stack tracker where students manage jobs, graduate programmes, bursaries, university applications and more in one place.
- Six-stage status pipeline (Saved to Offer) with a drag-and-drop board, a status history log and a dashboard that ranks upcoming deadlines by urgency and risk.
- Secure Supabase backend with authentication and Postgres Row Level Security on all tables, so every user can only access their own data. Includes password change, JSON data export and account deletion.
- Deployed on Vercel with demo accounts for different student stages.

BitBunker – Retro Arcade Games Hub (in development)

Oct 2026 – Present

Java | Spring Boot | PostgreSQL | Next.js | TypeScript | Tailwind CSS

GitHub: https://github.com/thatomakhusha/BitBunker

- Full-stack arcade platform with 15 planned games and per-game leaderboards.
- Building the game logic in Java using object-oriented design (classes, enums, encapsulated state), starting with a Number Guessing game with hint feedback.
- Developed the Next.js and TypeScript frontend from my own mockup: arcade game grid, callsign-based player identity and a typed API layer.
- Building the backend as a Spring Boot REST API with PostgreSQL storage for guest sessions and leaderboards (learning stage).

T's Cakes – Bakery Business Website

Sep 2026

Next.js | TypeScript | Tailwind CSS | Supabase

Live: https://tscakes.co.za

- Live client website that gives a bakery its online presence and showcases its products.
- Designed and developed a responsive website with custom branding and reusable React components using Tailwind CSS.
- Built a private admin hub with Supabase so the owner can approve or reject customer reviews without needing a developer.
- Registered the live site with Google Search Console and SEO tools so it can be found in Google search results.
- Optimised structure for accessibility, usability and performance across devices.

Golden Moments – Bakery Business Website Jul 2026

Next.js | TypeScript | Tailwind CSS

Live: https://golden-moments-gold.vercel.app/

- Live custom bakery website built around premium branding and user experience.
- Created a custom visual identity with tailored colour palettes, typography and layout.
- Developed a responsive landing page with reusable components, navigation and product-focused sections.
- Registered the live site with Google Search Console and SEO tools so it can be found in Google search results.

EDUCATION

Eduvos Pretoria – BSc Information Technology (Software Engineering) 2025 – 2027 (expected)

- **Academic Top Achiever**, Year 1 Block 1
- Relevant modules: Database Systems (Oracle SQL, MongoDB, Neo4j), Java

Curro Serengeti – IEB National Senior Certificate 2022

- Achievements: Academic Full Colours, Athletics Full Colours, Rugby Half Colours
- CAT (Computer Applications Technology) Olympiad: Bronze Certificate | Physics Olympiad: Participation Certificate

PROGRAMMES & TRAINING

Digititan Holdings – Cisco Cybersecurity Training Programme Oct – Nov 2026

- Courses: Introduction to Cybersecurity (completed), Endpoint Security, Cyber Threat Management, Cybersecurity Essentials, Network Defense (in progress).

FNB App Academy Jul 2026 – Present

- Completed a two-week Python development programme covering programming fundamentals and problem-solving.

FNB App of the Year Hackathon 2026 23–25 Oct 2026

- Took part as a solo team (Mai Solutions) in the Education challenge on access to higher education, building and submitting Pursuit with a live deployment, presentation deck and demo video.

AI Skills Acceleration Programme, CAPACITI 25–29 May 2026

- Completed an intensive one-week programme with practical exposure to AI tools and industry applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

Introduction to Cybersecurity, Cisco (2026) | Google AI Essentials, Google via Coursera (2026)

EXPERIENCE

Private Mathematics & CAT Tutor, Self-Employed 2024 – Present

- Tutor IEB and DBE learners in Mathematics and CAT with personalised learning plans.
- Prepare learners for examinations, assessments and practical tasks.

High School Mathematics Tutor, Tutors SA (Pty) Ltd May 2025 – Feb 2026

- Tutored a Grade 10 (IEB) student in Mathematics, improving understanding of core concepts and exam readiness.

Part-Time CAT Content Creator, Wingu Academy Nov 2025 – Jan 2026

- Developed curriculum-aligned lesson plans, study guides, worksheets and quizzes for Grade 12 learners.

LANGUAGES & REFERENCES

Languages: English, Setswana | **References:** Available upon request